GUIDANCE NOTES — remove these notes before sending

Landlord's 12-month notice to vacate at expiry

When to use

- You are the landlord and you need the property back when the tenancy ends, for one of the four reasons in Art. 25(2) only:
- (a) demolish and reconstruct, or add new structures that would prevent the tenant from using the property — with the required permits;
- (b) restoration or comprehensive maintenance that cannot be carried out while the tenant occupies the property — verified by a technical report issued or certified by Dubai Municipality;
- (c) the owner's own use, or use by a first-degree relative — the owner must prove he does not own any alternative suitable property;
- (d) the owner wishes to sell the property.
- Not wanting to renew for any other reason is not one of these grounds.

When to send it

- The landlord must notify the tenant of the reasons at least 12 months before the date of eviction (Art. 25(2)).
- Count back 12 months from the eviction date you want. The eviction date cannot be earlier than the contract expiry date.
- Example: contract expires 30 November 2027 and you want vacant possession that day → serve the notice no later than 30 November 2026.
- Older guides quote 90 days: that was the 2007 text, replaced in 2008. The period is 12 months.

How to deliver it

- This notice must be served through a Notary Public or by registered mail only (Law 26/2007 Art. 25, as amended by Law 33/2008). Hand delivery, email or WhatsApp alone are not the methods named for eviction notices.
- If the matter goes to the Rental Disputes Center, it asks for the notarised notice with the notification officer's report, or the registered post with the acknowledgement receipt (RDC filing page).
- Government notary fee to attest a notice: AED 200 (Executive Council Resolution 72/2025). Other charges may apply.

Own use: rule on re-letting

- If the Rental Disputes Center rules for the landlord on own use (ground c), the landlord may not rent the property to a third party for at least 2 years (residential) or 3 years (non-residential) from retaking possession (Art. 26).

Before you send — check

- Tick exactly one ground and attach the supporting document (permit, Dubai Municipality report, sale listing or agreement, or own-use statement).
- The eviction date is at least 12 months after the date of service and not before the contract expiry.
- Served by Notary Public or registered mail, and the proof is kept.

What this template does not do

- This template is general information. It does not decide whether the rule applies to your situation, and it does not interpret your tenancy contract. Disputes are decided by the Rental Disputes Center (Decree 26/2013).

General information and templates only, not legal advice. For your specific case consult a licensed legal practitioner in the UAE.

- This notice does not by itself remove a tenant. If the tenant does not leave, the Rental Disputes Center decides.

Legal basis (official sources, retrieved 2026-11-03)

- Law 26/2007 Art. 25(2) and Art. 26 as superseded by Law 33/2008 — https://dlp.dubai.gov.ae/Legislation%20Reference/2009/Law%20No.%20(33)%20of%202008%20Amending%20Law%20No.%20(26)%20of%202007.html
- RDC filing page (documents required for an eviction case) — https://rdc.gov.ae/en/eservices/register-first-instance-lawsuit-rental/
- Executive Council Resolution 72/2025, Schedule 1 (notary fee AED 200) — https://dlp.dubai.gov.ae/Legislation%20Reference/2025/Executive%20Council%20Resolution%20No.%20(72)%20of%202025%20Amending%20Executive%20Council%20Resolution.html

The English texts are the official translations published by the Supreme Legislation Committee, Dubai; the Arabic text prevails in case of conflict.

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[Sender's name and address, or letterhead]

Date: **[DD Month YYYY]**

To: **[Tenant full name, as in the tenancy contract]**

From: **[Landlord full name]** **[— or: through authorised agent [agent name]**, under **[power of attorney / management agreement ref]]**

Property: **[unit no.]**, **[building]**, **[community]**, Dubai

Ejari no.: **[number]** · Tenancy contract dated **[date]**, expiring on **[expiry date]**

Notice to vacate at the end of the tenancy — 12 months

Dear **[tenant name]**,

1. Under Article 25(2) of Law No. 26 of 2007 (as amended by Law No. 33 of 2008), I notify you that I require vacant possession of the property above on **[eviction date]**. This date is not earlier than the contract expiry date of **[expiry date]** and is at least twelve (12) months after the date this notice is served on you.

2. The reason (one only):

☐ (d) I wish to sell the property.

☐ (c) I wish to retake possession for my own use / for use by my first-degree relative **[name, relationship]**. I confirm that I do not own any alternative real property suitable for this purpose.

☐ (a) I wish to demolish and reconstruct the property / add new structures that would prevent its use. Permit reference: **[ref]**.

☐ (b) The property requires restoration or comprehensive maintenance that cannot be carried out while it is occupied. Dubai Municipality technical report reference: **[ref]**.

3. Supporting documents attached: **[list]**.

4. Please contact me to arrange the handover inspection and the return of the security deposit in line with the tenancy contract.

Yours sincerely,

Signature: _____

Name: **[full name]** · Capacity: **[Landlord / authorised agent of the landlord]**

Phone / email: **[contact details]**

Proof of delivery (keep with your copy)

Method	Reference / evidence	Date
Notary Public — notification officer's report	**[ref]**	**[date]**
Registered mail — acknowledgement receipt	**[ref]**	**[date]**

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